

SS45/15 - The UK leverage ratio framework

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Supervisory statement 45/15

First published on 7 December 2015

This Supervisory Statement (SS) applies to Capital Requirements Regulation (CRR) firms (hereafter 'firms') and CRR consolidation entities on an individual, consolidated, and where relevant, sub-consolidated basis. The purpose of this SS is to give guidance on the UK leverage ratio capital requirements and buffers for firms in scope of the leverage ratio capital requirement, and to set out the Prudential Regulatory Authority's (PRA) expectation as to how other firms will manage their risk of excessive leverage. It also provides guidance on the methodology for additional reporting and disclosure of an averaged leverage ratio for firms in scope of the leverage ratio capital requirement. It should be read alongside the Leverage Ratio - Capital Requirements and Buffers, Leverage Ratio (CRR), Disclosure (CRR), Reporting (CRR) and Internal Capital Adequacy Assessment Parts of the PRA rulebook. This statement complements the PRA's rules in implementing the Financial Policy Committee's Direction and Recommendation with regard to a UK leverage ratio framework.

As stated in the updated SS, firms that are the parents of global systemically important institutions (G-SIIs) and firms subject to an 'other systemically important institutions' (O-SII) buffer to which the UK leverage ratio framework applies will be invited to apply for a voluntary requirement (VREQ) under section 55M of the Financial Services and Market Act (2000). Holding companies that are the parents of G-SII groups to which the UK leverage ratio framework applies will be set a consolidated (G-SII) ALRB via a PRA direction under section 192C of the Financial Services and Market Act (2000). For more information please see the Additional Leverage Ratio Buffers Model Requirements.

As stated in the updated SS, firms that are subject to the leverage ratio capital requirement on an individual basis and have subsidiaries that can be consolidated may apply to the PRA for a permission under section 144G of FSMA that replaces that individual requirement with a sub-consolidated requirement. When applying, firms will have to demonstrate that they meet the condition for sub-consolidation set out in SS45/15. The PRA will consider on a case-by case basis whether to grant the application. The application form is available at Permissions (CRR firms). Applications should be sent to PRA-waivers@bankofengland.co.uk copying in the relevant supervisory area. This application is not subject to a fee.

Current version

Published on 12 November 2025. Effective from 1 January 2026.

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 - November 2025 (pdf)

↳ following PS22/25 - Leverage Ratio: Changes to the retail deposits threshold for application of the requirement

Past versions

* ### List of past versions

Published 12 February 2025. Effective from 31 March 2025.

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 - February 2025 (pdf)

\- following PS2/25 - Streamlining firm-specific capital communications

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Published on 29 July 2024. Effective from 5 August 2024.

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 - July 2024 (pdf)

\- following PS14/24 - Leverage ratio treatment of omnibus account reserves and minor amendments to the leverage ratio framework

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Published 11 May 2023. Effective from 1 January 2024.

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 - May 2023 (pdf)

\- following PS5/23 - Risks from contingent leverage

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Published 8 August 2022. Effective from 1 September 2022.

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 - August 2022 (pdf)

\- following PS7/22 'Responses to Occasional Consultation Paper' - March 2022.

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Published 8 October 2021. Effective from 1 January 2022.

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 - October 2021 (pdf)

- following PS21/21 'The UK leverage ratio framework'

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Published 28 December 2020. Effective from 29 December 2020 (superseded in January 2022 by October 2021 version).

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 - December 2020 (pdf)

\- following PS29/20 'Capital Requirements Directive V (CRD V)'.

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Published 14 November 2018. Effective from 1 January 2019 (superseded on 29 December 2020 by December 2020 version).

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 - November 2018 (PDF)

\- following Policy Statement 28/18 'UK leverage ratio: Applying the framework to systemic ring-fenced bodies and reflecting the systemic risk buffer'.

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Published 7 December 2015. Effective from 7 December 2015 (superseded on 1 January 2019 by November 2018 version).

* Supervisory Statement 45/15 (PDF)

First publication of SS.

Prudential Regulation // PRA Regulatory Digest 02 March 2026

Prudential Regulation // PRA statement 27 February 2026

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